How have our* social lifes and media habits changed since the 1990s?

*people in Germany, aged 15-29 years old

From 1990s to 2020s the media technology changed drastically, from the introduction of the internet and personal computers , all the way to the fight over our attention span by large corporates with the help of always-available and quick-to-reach smartphones combined with fast paced media formats like short-form videos plus intentional addiciting design patterns like the endless scroll and personalised algorithms.

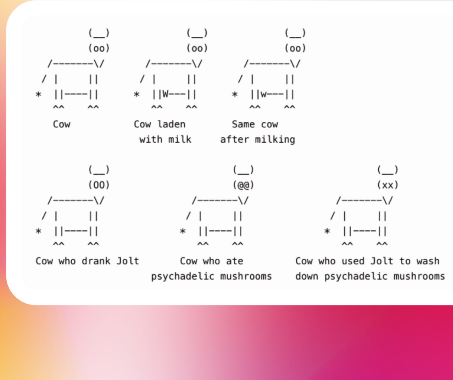
But how did that affect the broad youth in Germany? Did it lead to a general new time share of how we go through our day? Or were only parts of the youth society affected by it?

wash
body
vistors/ visiting
house-hold chat
going out
cleaning/tidying up

1990s

39

Visits peaked at an average of 39 minutes a day. The doorbell was the notification. Ignoring it meant hiding quietly behind the sofa.

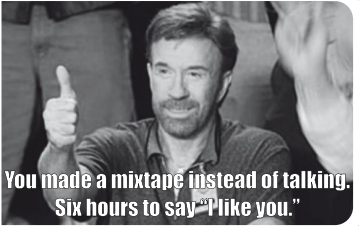

Cow
Cow laden with milk
Same cow after milking
Cow who drank Jolt
Cow who ate psychadelic mushrooms
Cow who used Jolt to wash down psychadelic mushrooms

RealityTV@home! In-person household chats peaked at 39 minutes a day on average in the 2000s. An unpaid cast. Stay tuned!

39

2000s

house-hold chat
wash
body
homework
travel time for social life
going out


You made a mixtape instead of talking.
Six hours to say "I like you."

Local shopping (9) and resting (10) both peaked in the 2010s. That can't be a coincidence. Luckily we'evolved to sitting on the sofa while shopping.

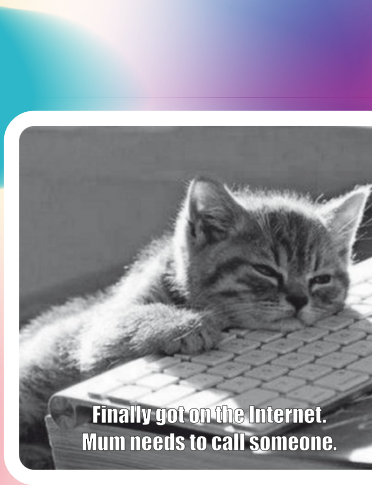
9.
10.

2010s

33

PC/Smartphone use averaged 33 minutes a day in the 2010s. "use" meaning throwing your keyboard after Moving a picture in Word.

wash
body
house-hold chat
gaming (PC/Notebook)
local shopping
resting


Finally got on the Internet.
Mum needs to call someone.

wash
body
gaming (PC/Notebook)
visitors/ visiting
social media
courses prep/follow-up

2020s

8.

social media entered at 8th: 19 min a day, adding up to nearly five days a year. Just a quick look? More like you should pack underwear.

1990s vs 2020s

Probably never the medium for the youth, flipping through a newspaper, sipping a coffee and being under 30 can only be sold by Philipp Amthor.

24.
45.
75.
98.

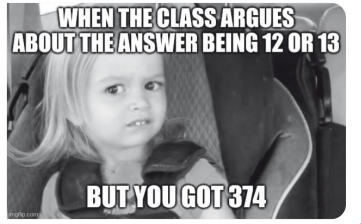
An image that never really suited us

"YOU CAN'T HEAR A PICTURE"
THE PICTURE:

Building a house! Or at least renovating your home has probably thanks to more time at home, #covid, gained some ranks.

45.
83.
96.
106.

Call it a comeback for heavy-duty DIY?



1990s
2000s
2010s
2020s

Skyrocketing, and it all started with Minesweeper and Tetris. The only discussion that remains if you're a PC, console or phone gamer.

Eat this PISA, we do still read books!

28.
30.
41.
43.

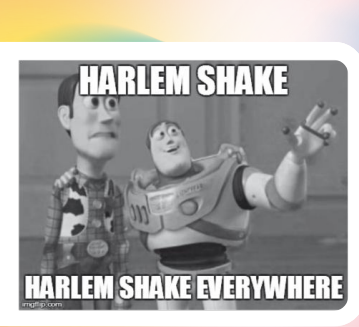
Might help that reading books electronically also counts towards this activ ity. Nonetheless, reading books remains an activity we enjoy.

More time eating, less time talking. Perhaps "don't talk with your mouth full" was the most effective communication policy ever.

household chats
-16

eating & drinking
+16

Moving an image in Word
I decided to not use an image



1990s
2000s
2010s
2020s

After sleep and work our biggest constant: Watching a screen displaying about 60 images/s. TV, streaming, whatever your medium is.

More exercising, less time reading the newspapers. Or seems like we found a way to cope with the current and future world events.

reading newspaper
-4

fitness & gymnastics
+4

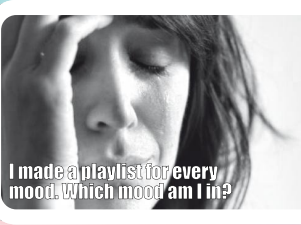
From '90s to '20s, sleep gained 32 min a day on average. Somewhere between the alarm clock and phone alarm, snoozing got an extension.

+32

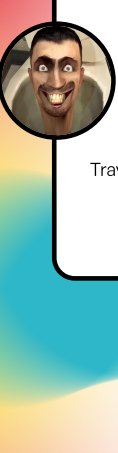
We found a way back to museums and art!

72.
103.
121.
123.

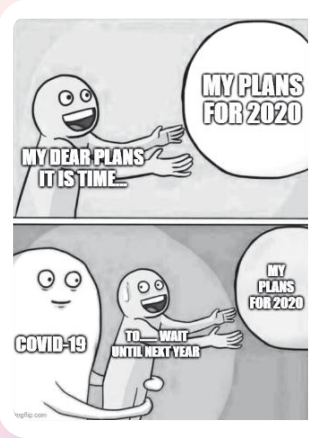
To be fair, never was really up there, but it seems like we found a way back to enjoying the craft of offline museums and art.


I made a playlist for every mood. Which mood am I in?

-15



Travel for social contact fell by 15 min a day on average from the '90s to the '20s. Replaced by snaps from the convenience of the toilet?


MY PLANS FOR 2020
MY DEAR PLANS IT IS TIME
MY PLANS FOR 2020
COVID-19
TO... WAIT UNTIL NEXT YEAR

kino.to? Wikipedia? Using the browser at all? Seems like we reached the browsing peak in the 2010s. Metaverse? Or what's next?

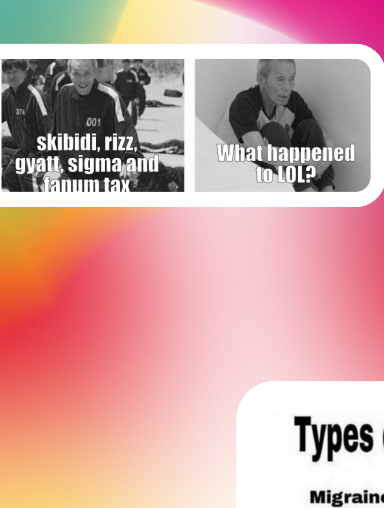
1990s
2000s
2010s
2020s

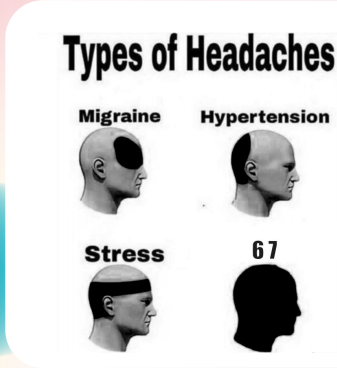
telling a friend i miss them
sending "us" under a TikTok of two raccoons committing a felony

reading
-8

theme parks, circus & fairs
+8

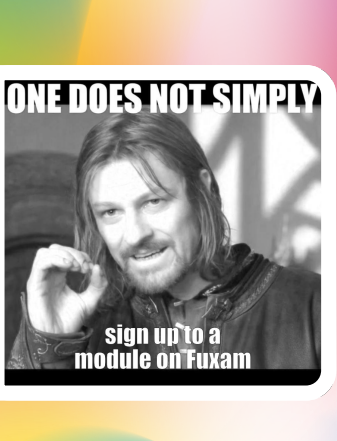
More time for theme parks, less time reading. Perhaps we still enjoy a good story. We just want it to last 90s and turn us upside down.


skibidi, rizz, gyatt, sigma and fanum tax
What happened to LOL?



Going out fell by 12 min a day on average from the '90s to the '20s. Disco wants to discuss its reduced role. Could have been an email.

-12


ONE DOES NOT SIMPLY
sign up to a module on Fuxam

travel time to work
-7

baking
+7

More time commuting, less time baking. So much for the homeoffice sourdough fantasy. Trends suggest the starter has been abandoned.

-11

DIY and repairs fell by 11 min a day on average from the '90s to the '20s. "I made this.", "I found this." Both look good on the feed.